

Nyhavn

Summary

Nyhavn is Copenhagen's most famous canal, created in the 17th century to allow trading ships to sail directly into the city center. Known for its colorful historic houses and old wooden ships, it was once a busy commercial harbor and later a lively sailors' district. Today, Nyhavn is one of the city's most photographed places and a symbol of Copenhagen's maritime history and culture.

Details.

Nyhavn was built in the 1670s during the reign of King Christian V. The main purpose of the canal was to connect the sea with the city center so that trading ships could bring goods such as spices, wine, and food directly into Copenhagen.

At that time, Denmark and Sweden were often at war. Many Swedish soldiers were captured and brought to Copenhagen as prisoners of war. These Swedish prisoners were forced to dig the canal, making Nyhavn an important part of both Danish history and Nordic conflict history.

Copenhagen was strongly inspired by Amsterdam, which was one of Europe's most important trading cities at the time. That is why Nyhavn was designed with a canal and narrow, colorful houses similar to those found in Amsterdam.

The oldest building in Nyhavn is House No. 9, the small blue house with the year 1681 written on it. Many of the buildings along the canal date back to the late 17th and early 18th centuries and are now protected as historical buildings.

Nyhavn was once a rough and lively area filled with sailors, taverns, and prostitution. It was known as a red-light district in earlier times. People also had to pay tax based on the number of windows in their houses, which is why some buildings are narrow and have fewer windows.

The famous Danish writer Hans Christian Andersen lived in Nyhavn at three different addresses: Nyhavn 18, Nyhavn 20, Nyhavn 67

He wrote several of his well-known fairy tales while living here, which makes Nyhavn an important place in Danish literary history.

Today, Nyhavn has changed from a working harbor and sailors' district into one of Copenhagen's most popular tourist areas. It is now full of cafés, restaurants, and historic wooden ships. Nyhavn shows how Copenhagen developed from a trading port into a modern cultural city.

Amalienborg Palace

Summary.

Amalienborg Palace is the home of the Danish royal family and one of Copenhagen's most important landmarks. The palace complex was created by King Frederik V as part of a grand city project called Frederiksstaden, together with the Marble Church.

Four elegant palaces surround an octagonal square, and in the middle you can see the impressive statue of King Frederik V. Visitors will also see the Royal Guards safeguarding the palace and have the opportunity to go close to them and take photos. Every day, guests can experience the famous Changing of the Guard ceremony.

Description

Amalienborg was planned by King Frederik V in the 18th century as part of the Frederiksstaden district, a prestigious area designed to celebrate the power of the Danish monarchy and the 300th anniversary of the Oldenburg royal dynasty. The project was led by the architect Nicolai Eigtved, who designed the square with perfect symmetry and harmony in the Rococo style.

Originally, the four palaces were not meant to be the king's own residence. Instead, they were built for four of his closest noblemen and trusted figures. Only later, after a fire destroyed Christiansborg Palace in 1794, did the royal family move into Amalienborg and make it their main residence.

The four palaces today

Each palace now has a specific role:

One palace is used as the main residence of the Danish royal family.

One palace is used for Queen Margrethe II (winter residence).

One palace is used to host royal guests and official ceremonies.

One palace functions as a museum and part of the Royal Collection.

This shows how Amalienborg is both a living royal home and a historical site.

The statue of King Frederik V

In the center of the square stands the equestrian statue of King Frederik V. The statue took about 20 years to complete. Unfortunately, the king died before the statue was finished.

The statue was created by the French sculptor Jacques-François-Joseph Saly, who worked on it for many years and was paid hourly, which made it one of the most expensive statues in Danish history at that time. It was finally unveiled in 1771 and became a powerful symbol of royal authority and stability.

Connection to the Marble Church

At the same time as Amalienborg was planned, King Frederik V also ordered the construction of Frederik's Church (The Marble Church) as part of the Frederiksstaden project. The church was meant to be a grand religious monument close to the royal residence.

However, the project ran into serious financial problems, and the king eventually went bankrupt. As a result, the Marble Church remained unfinished for more than 100 years.

In the late 19th century, one of Denmark's richest businessmen, Carl Frederik Tietgen, decided to finance the completion of the church. Thanks to his support, the Marble Church was finally completed and opened in 1894, becoming one of Copenhagen's most famous landmarks with the largest dome in Scandinavia.

Marble Church

Summary

Marble Church, also known as the Frederik's Church, is one of Copenhagen's most impressive landmarks, famous for its large green dome inspired by St. Peter's Basilica in Rome. The church was planned in 1749 by King Frederik V as part of the Frederiksstaden district together with Amalienborg Palace and was finally completed in 1894 after more than 140 years. Visitors can admire its grand architecture and enjoy beautiful views of the city from the dome.

Description.

Frederik's Church, commonly called the Marble Church, was planned in 1749 by King Frederik V as part of the grand Frederiksstaden project. It was designed to be a monumental church close to the royal residence at Amalienborg and to celebrate the power and prestige of the Danish monarchy.

The architect Nicolai Eigtved originally planned the church in a grand Baroque style with a large dome inspired by St. Peter's Basilica in Rome. However, the construction faced serious financial and political problems. After the king went bankrupt and priorities changed, the project stopped, and the church remained unfinished for more than 100 years.

In the late 19th century, one of Denmark's richest businessmen, Carl Frederik Tietgen, decided to finance the completion of the church. Thanks to his support, Frederik's Church was finally completed and opened in 1894.

The dome of the Marble Church is the largest church dome in Scandinavia. It rests on 12 large columns and creates a strong visual connection with Amalienborg Palace, forming a symbolic line between church and monarchy.

Today, the Marble Church is both a place of worship and a popular visitor attraction. Guests can enter the church for free and, in good weather, go up to the dome to enjoy panoramic views over Copenhagen, including the harbor and the royal palaces.

The Little Mermaid

Summary

The Little Mermaid is Copenhagen's most famous statue and one of the city's most visited attractions. Inspired by the fairy tale of Hans Christian Andersen, the statue was unveiled in 1913 and sits quietly on a rock by the harbor. It has become a symbol of Denmark's storytelling tradition and Copenhagen's close connection to the sea.

Description

The Little Mermaid statue was unveiled in 1913 and is based on the famous fairy tale written by Hans Christian Andersen. The idea for the statue came from Carl Jacobsen, the founder of the Carlsberg Brewery, after he saw a ballet performance inspired by the story. He asked the sculptor Edvard Eriksen to create the statue.

The statue shows the mermaid sitting on a rock, looking toward the sea and the human world. Many visitors are surprised by how small and simple the statue is. This reflects Danish values of modesty and simplicity rather than building large and dramatic monuments.

The fairy tale tells the story of a young mermaid who dreams of becoming human after falling in love with a prince. She makes a deal with a sea witch and gives up her beautiful voice in exchange for human legs.

Although she reaches the human world, the prince falls in love with another woman. The mermaid is given a chance to save herself by harming the prince, but she refuses because she truly loves him. In the end, she sacrifices herself and becomes a spirit of the sea, symbolizing love, selflessness, and longing.

Unlike the Disney version, Hans Christian Andersen's original story has a sad and poetic ending, which gives the statue a deeper emotional meaning.

Over the years, the Little Mermaid has been vandalised several times and has also been used in political protests and artistic expressions.

1964: The statue was beheaded for the first time. The head was later found and returned.

1984: The statue's right arm was cut off and later restored.

1998: The statue was beheaded again, and this time the head was never officially recovered.

The statue has also been attacked with paint and graffiti on several occasions.

Despite these incidents, the statue has always been repaired and placed back on its rock, showing how important it is to Danish culture and national identity.

In 2010, the Little Mermaid statue was temporarily moved from Copenhagen to the Shanghai World Expo in China. This was the first time the original statue ever left Denmark.

During this period, a video installation was placed on the rock in Copenhagen instead of the statue. The move showed how important the Little Mermaid is as an international symbol of Denmark and Copenhagen.

Kastellet

Summary

Kastellet is one of the best-preserved star-shaped fortresses in Northern Europe and a peaceful green oasis in Copenhagen. Founded as a defensive fortification in 1626 under King Christian IV, the site later developed into the citadel we see today. It is still an active military area with military offices and barracks, while also being open to the public for walks along the ramparts and canals. The iconic windmill is a reminder that a fortress had to be prepared for siege conditions, including the ability to grind grain into flour for soldiers' supplies.

Description

Kastellet began as a defensive work ordered by King Christian IV in 1626, built to strengthen Copenhagen's protection—especially toward the east and the harbour approaches. Later, after Copenhagen's vulnerability was exposed during Swedish attacks in the mid-1600s, the defenses were expanded and reshaped into the classic star-fort design, which made it easier to defend all angles and reduce blind spots. Today, it remains an active military area, which is why some buildings function as military offices and barracks even though the grounds are open for visitors.

A strong “daily life” detail here is the windmill. The current windmill was built in 1847 (replacing an earlier one from 1718 that was destroyed in 1846), and it illustrates the practical reality of fortress life: in a fortified city, secure food supplies mattered, and milling grain into flour was part of being prepared for siege conditions.

Kastellet is also linked to one of Denmark's most dramatic royal-political episodes. After the palace coup on 17 January 1772, Johann Friedrich Struensee (together with Enevold Brandt) was imprisoned at Kastellet for 15 weeks, until they were taken out on 28 April 1772 to the execution site at Øster Fælled. This gives guides a powerful moment to connect the calm atmosphere of the fortress today with the tension of court politics in the 1700s.

The Gefion Fountain

Summary.

The Gefion Fountain is one of Copenhagen's largest and most dramatic fountains, located near Kastellet and the harbor. It shows the Nordic goddess Gefion driving four powerful oxen and tells a legendary story about the creation of the island of Zealand. Donated by the Carlsberg founder Carl Jacobsen and unveiled in 1908, the fountain is a striking blend of mythology, art, and Danish history.

Description

The Gefion Fountain was unveiled in 1908 and was a gift to the city of Copenhagen from Carl Jacobsen, the founder of the Carlsberg Brewery. It was created by the Danish sculptor Anders Bundgaard and originally planned to stand near City Hall, but it was later placed here close to Kastellet and the harbor, where it fits naturally into the landscape.

The fountain is inspired by a story from Norse mythology. According to the legend, the Swedish king promised the goddess Gefion as much land as she could plow in one night. Gefion turned her four sons into oxen and plowed so deeply into the earth that a huge piece of land was torn away and thrown into the sea. This land became the island of Zealand (Sjælland), where Copenhagen is located. The hole left behind became Lake Mälaren in Sweden.

The sculpture shows Gefion struggling with the oxen in a powerful and dynamic movement, symbolizing strength, determination, and the mythical origin of Denmark's landscape. Water flows around the figures, giving the impression of motion and energy.

The fountain also reflects the period of National Romanticism, when Denmark celebrated its myths, history, and cultural identity through art and architecture. It connects nature, mythology, and national pride in one single monument.

Today, the Gefion Fountain is both a popular photo stop and a storytelling point where guides can link Danish mythology with Copenhagen's geography and history. Its location near Kastellet and the harbor makes it a natural continuation of the city's narrative from military defense to cultural symbolism.

Rosenborg Castle

Summary

Rosenborg Castle is a beautiful Renaissance castle built by King Christian IV in the early 17th century and surrounded by the King's Garden, Denmark's oldest royal park. Construction began in 1606, and the castle reached its present form by 1624, with interior additions continuing until 1634. Today, Rosenborg is famous for housing the Danish Crown Jewels and royal treasures. The Royal Life Guards are based at the barracks next to Rosenborg Castle, and every day in the late morning (around 11:30 AM) they begin their ceremonial march through the city toward Amalienborg Palace for the Changing of the Guard ceremony at noon.

Description

The castle was built in the Dutch Renaissance style and was originally surrounded by countryside and gardens. As Copenhagen expanded, the area developed into what is now known as King's Garden (Kongens Have), the oldest royal garden in Denmark and today one of the city's most popular parks.

Rosenborg later became a place for royal collections rather than a permanent royal residence. Inside the castle, visitors can see richly decorated rooms, royal furniture, portraits, and personal belongings from different Danish kings. The most famous section is the Treasury in the basement, where the Danish Crown Jewels and Royal Regalia are kept.

Among the highlights are the crown of King Christian IV and the crown of Queen Sophie Magdalene, as well as the coronation thrones made of silver and guarded by three life-size silver lions. These treasures are still used today for important royal ceremonies.

Rosenborg also plays an important role in modern royal traditions. The Royal Life Guards are based at the barracks beside Rosenborg Castle, and every day at around 11:30 AM they leave the barracks and march through Copenhagen toward Amalienborg Palace for the Changing of the Guard ceremony at 12:00 PM. This makes Rosenborg not only a historical monument but also part of Denmark's living monarchy and daily royal traditions.

Rosenborg tells the story of Denmark's monarchy from the Renaissance period to modern times and shows how royal power has been expressed through architecture, art, and ceremony for more than 400 years.

Christiansborg Palace

Summary

Christiansborg Palace is the center of Denmark's political life and one of Copenhagen's most important landmarks. Originally built under **King Christian IV**, the palace has been destroyed by fire twice, in **1794** and **1884**, and rebuilt on the same historic site. Today, it houses the Danish Parliament, the Supreme Court, and the Prime Minister's Office, while also serving as a venue for royal ceremonies and official events.

Description

Christiansborg Palace stands on Slotsholmen, a site that has been the center of power in Denmark for more than 800 years. The first castle was built here by Bishop Absalon in the 12th century. Later, a grand palace was developed under King Christian IV, making the area a royal and political center of the kingdom.

Christiansborg has been destroyed by fire twice: first in 1794 and again in 1884. After each fire, the palace was rebuilt on the same foundations, which is why today's Christiansborg contains layers of medieval, royal, and modern political history in one building. The current palace was completed in 1928.

One remarkable detail is that the Royal Stables and the horse riding ground (the Riding Arena) survived both fires. These areas are among the oldest parts of the complex and are still used today, showing continuity between royal traditions of the past and present-day ceremonies.

Christiansborg is unique in the world because it brings together all three branches of Danish state power in one building:

- the Danish Parliament (Folketinget)
- the Supreme Court
- the Prime Minister's Office

At the same time, parts of the palace are still used by the royal family for official events, such as banquets, receptions, and state ceremonies.

The Danish monarch still plays a constitutional role in government. The King comes to Christiansborg about once a week to formally sign new laws and official documents, connecting modern democracy with centuries of royal tradition.

Behind the palace, in the courtyard area, important national ceremonies take place. Most recently, the coronation celebrations of King Frederik X in 2024 were connected to this area, showing how Christiansborg continues to be a stage for Denmark's most important historical moments.

Christiansborg represents the development of Denmark from a medieval kingdom to a modern democratic state. It is a place where royal history, political power, and national ceremonies come together in one location.

Nyboder

Summary

Nyboder is a historic district of bright yellow houses built in the 17th century to provide homes for sailors of the Danish Navy. Founded by King Christian IV, it is one of Copenhagen's oldest residential areas and still partly used by naval personnel today. Nyboder offers a unique glimpse into everyday life of sailors and their families in early modern Denmark.

Description

Nyboder was established in the early 1600s by King Christian IV as housing for sailors and workers of the Danish Navy. At that time, Copenhagen was developing into an important naval and trading city, and the king needed a stable place for his sailors and their families to live close to the harbor and the shipyards.

The houses were built in long, straight rows and painted in a distinctive yellow color, which later became known as "Nyboder yellow." This uniform design reflected discipline and order, values strongly connected to military life. Each house was small and simple, showing how modest the living conditions were for ordinary sailors.

Nyboder was not only a place to live but also a close-knit community with its own rules, traditions, and daily routines. Families shared water wells and courtyards, and life was

strongly shaped by naval service and royal authority.

Unlike many other historical districts, Nyboder has survived wars, fires, and modernization. Some of the houses are still owned by the Danish Defence and are used as accommodation for naval personnel, making Nyboder one of the few places in Copenhagen where military housing continues in the same area after more than 350 years.

Today, Nyboder stands as a symbol of Denmark's naval history and social planning. It shows how the monarchy cared for its sailors by providing organized housing and how Copenhagen developed from a fortified naval city into a modern capital. Walking through Nyboder feels like stepping back into the everyday life of 17th-century Copenhagen.

Gammel Strand.

Summary.

Gammel Strand is one of Copenhagen's oldest waterfront areas and marks the city's original shoreline. The area is closely linked to Copenhagen's early beginnings as a Viking-age fishing settlement and later became the city's main fish market for centuries. Today, Gammel Strand is known for its historic buildings, art galleries, and its role as a bridge between Copenhagen's medieval past and modern cultural life.

Description.

Gammel Strand means "Old Shore," and it shows where Copenhagen's original coastline once was before land reclamation changed the shape of the city. Archaeological and historical sources connect this area with Copenhagen's earliest beginnings as a Viking-age fishing settlement in the 10th century, long before the city was officially founded in 1167 by Bishop Absalon.

During the Middle Ages and for many centuries afterward, Gammel Strand became Copenhagen's most important fish market. Fishermen and fish sellers brought their catch directly to this waterfront, and the area was known for its lively daily trade, strong smells, and crowded atmosphere. It was a central place of everyday life for ordinary citizens and stood close to the political and royal center at Slotsholmen and Christiansborg Palace.

The area was badly damaged in the great Copenhagen fires of 1728 and 1795, after which many of the buildings were rebuilt in the style that can still be seen today. Over time, Gammel Strand slowly changed from a working harbor and market into a residential and cultural quarter.

In the 19th century, artists, writers, and intellectuals were attracted to the area, and Gammel Strand became known for its creative and bohemian atmosphere. This artistic tradition continues today with galleries, cafés, and cultural institutions along the canal.

In 1958, the large-scale fish trade was moved away from Gammel Strand to a new fish market in Sydhavnen, marking the end of its long role as the city's main marketplace for fish.

Today, Gammel Strand represents the transformation of Copenhagen from a small coastal settlement and Viking-age fishing village into a medieval trading town and finally into a modern capital city. It connects water, history, art, and everyday life in one of the city's most atmospheric streets.

Strøget

Summary

Strøget is one of Europe's longest pedestrian shopping streets and one of Copenhagen's most lively areas. Stretching from City Hall Square to Kongens Nytorv, it has been a central part of city life for centuries. Along the way, visitors pass Gammeltorv and Nytorv, two of the city's oldest market squares, which played an important role in Copenhagen's commercial and social history.

Description.

Strøget is not one single street but a series of connected streets running from City Hall Square (Rådhuspladsen) to Kongens Nytorv. It passes through Gammeltorv and Nytorv, which together formed the heart of medieval Copenhagen's market life.

Gammeltorv is the oldest square in Copenhagen and was traditionally used as a marketplace where farmers and merchants sold food and goods. Nytorv, meaning "New Square," was created later and became an important place for public life and justice, including court activities and public announcements. Together, these two squares were central meeting points for trade, punishment, and everyday city life.

Before becoming a pedestrian street, Strøget was open to traffic. In 1962, the city closed it to cars and transformed it into a pedestrian zone. This decision was controversial at first but later became a model for car-free city centers around the world.

Historically, this route has always been one of Copenhagen's main commercial and social arteries. Merchants, craftsmen, and traders worked here for centuries, and royal processions and public events often passed through these squares.

Today, Strøget combines historic buildings, modern shops, cafés, and street performers. It shows how Copenhagen blends medieval marketplaces with modern urban life and represents the city's development into a pedestrian-friendly and people-focused capital.

Christianshavn

Summary

Christianshavn is a historic waterfront district inspired by the canals of Amsterdam and founded by **King Christian IV** in the early 17th century. Built on reclaimed land surrounded by fortifications, the area was designed with canals and narrow streets to support trade and defense. Today, Christianshavn is known for its houseboats, colorful buildings, and relaxed atmosphere by the water.

Description.

Christianshavn was founded in 1618 by King Christian IV, who was strongly inspired by the city of Amsterdam, one of Europe's most successful trading cities at that time. He wanted to create a new district in Copenhagen that looked and functioned like Amsterdam, with canals, warehouses, and narrow streets where ships could bring goods directly into the city.

To make this possible, Christianshavn had to be built on reclaimed land. First, defensive walls and bastions were constructed to form a protected area. Then soil, stones, and waste materials from the city were thrown into the water behind these fortifications. Over time, the land slowly rose out of the sea, and a new town was created where there had once been only water.

Christianshavn was originally planned as both a trading district and a military defense area. The canals made transport easy, while the walls protected the city from attacks coming from the sea. Merchants, sailors, and craftsmen settled here, and the area quickly became an important part of Copenhagen's harbor life.

Over the centuries, Christianshavn developed a strong maritime identity and community spirit. Many of the old warehouses and canal-side buildings still reflect its trading past.

Today, Christianshavn is one of Copenhagen's most popular neighborhoods, famous for its canals, houseboats, cafés, and cultural diversity. It is also home to important landmarks such as the Church of Our Saviour and Christiania. Christianshavn shows how Copenhagen expanded by turning water into land and by copying successful ideas from other European cities, especially Amsterdam.

Freetown Christiania

Summary

Freetown Christiania is a unique alternative community founded in 1971 on part of Copenhagen's old military ramparts after the Danish army left the area in the late 1960s. Known for its colorful houses, creative lifestyle, and strong sense of community, Christiania has developed its own identity, including a red flag with three yellow dots. Today, it represents a different side of Copenhagen's modern history and culture.

Description

The area known today as Freetown Christiania was originally part of Copenhagen's old defensive ramparts and later used as a military zone by the Danish army. After military activity declined and the barracks were abandoned in the late 1960s, the area stood empty for a short period.

In 1971, a group of hippies, artists, and activists moved into the empty buildings and declared the area a free town. Their goal was to create a community based on freedom, creativity, and shared responsibility, outside traditional political and social structures. Many of the houses were built or modified by residents themselves using recycled materials, which gave Christiania its distinctive and unconventional architectural style.

Christiania developed its own symbols and identity, including its flag — a red background with three yellow dots. Over the years, it became known for its alternative culture, music, art, and collective decision-making.

For many decades, one street inside Christiania, called Pusher Street, became associated with the open sale of cannabis. Although cannabis has always been illegal in Denmark, this activity was at times tolerated and became part of Christiania's public image. Because of this, visitors were traditionally asked not to take photographs in certain parts of Christiania, and signs were placed to protect residents' privacy and avoid conflict.

In 2024, Christiania residents and Danish authorities agreed to end open drug trading in Pusher Street. Since then, the area has focused more on its cultural, residential, and artistic identity.

Christiania shows a very different Copenhagen compared to the rest of the city. Its culture, building styles, and social values are unlike traditional Danish neighborhoods, making it an important place to talk about freedom movements, alternative communities, and modern social experiments in Denmark.

Today, Christiania is both a residential community and a visitor attraction. Guests are welcome to walk through the area, enjoy cafés and cultural venues, and learn about one of Europe's longest-running alternative communities.

The Church of Our Saviour

Summary

The Church of Our Saviour (Vor Frelzers Kirke) is a famous baroque church in Christianshavn, built in the late 17th century and known for its dramatic spiral tower with an outdoor staircase. The tower, completed in 1752, offers one of Copenhagen's best panoramic views

after climbing 400 steps, including the final 150 on the outdoor spiral ramp. The church combines religious history, architectural distinction, and citywide views in a single landmark.

Description

The Church of Our Saviour was built in Christianshavn in the late 1600s as the main parish church for the growing harbor district established by King Christian IV. Construction of the present structure began in 1682, based on a design by Lambert van Haven, and it was inaugurated in the 1690s. However, its most iconic feature — the beloved spiral tower — was added later.

The spiral spire was designed by architect Lauritz de Thurah and was completed and inaugurated in 1752. The tower's design takes inspiration from Italian baroque architecture, especially the corkscrew appearance of churches like Sant'Ivo alla Sapienza in Rome. This baroque flair makes the tower instantly recognizable and a beloved symbol of Copenhagen's skyline.

The tower itself has a timber-framed structure, which was common in tall constructions of the period. From ground level it appears solid and stable, but as visitors climb higher, some people feel a slight movement in the staircase, especially on windy days — a sensation that many visitors remember vividly. This is not a weakness, but an honest reminder of how tall and slender the structure is.

Inside, there are 400 steps to the top. The staircase becomes progressively narrower as you ascend, and the final 150 steps are on the outdoor spiral ramp winding around the tower. This part of the climb is exposed to the sky, which makes the ascent both thrilling and unique. Because of this, guides should advise visitors to be comfortable with heights and to wear sturdy shoes. The outdoor spiral section also offers sweeping views even before you reach the summit.

Historically, the height of the tower was practical as well as symbolic. In earlier centuries, towers like this functioned as natural lookout points, especially in a city built around waterways and trade routes. From the upper reaches of the tower, guards would have had expansive views of the harbor, the surrounding lowlands, and any approaching ships — key information in a fortified capital like Copenhagen.

The church also has a special place in more modern history. During World War II, members of the Danish resistance used the tower and its upper spaces as storage and hiding places for weapons and equipment during the occupation. This connection to the resistance adds another layer to the church's story of resilience and national identity.

Today, the Church of Our Saviour remains one of Copenhagen's most visited attractions. Many visitors come for the climb, the views, and the unforgettable experience of ascending the winding outdoor stairway. Others come to appreciate the church's architectural boldness, historical narratives, and peaceful interior space.

The Copenhagen Opera House

Summary

The Copenhagen Opera House (Operaen) is Denmark's national opera house and one of the city's most striking modern landmarks. Located on Holmen directly across the harbour from Amalienborg, it was designed by Henning Larsen and completed in 2004, with the official opening in January 2005. The building has 14 floors—five underground—which is why it looks less tall than many visitors expect, and it's famous for its dramatic roof overhang and grand interiors.

Description

Operaen stands on Holmen, facing the historic royal city across the water. It's one of the best places to explain how Copenhagen mixes old and new: on one side you have palaces and historic churches, and here you have one of the biggest modern cultural buildings in Denmark.

A “wow” detail for guests is the scale. The Opera House has 14 floors in total, but five of them are underground. That's why, from many angles, it doesn't look as tall as it actually is—so much of the building is hidden below street level.

The building is also tied to the history beneath Copenhagen's harbour area. During archaeological work connected to the Opera House site, a shipwreck was excavated; the timber was dated to around 1420–1425, meaning it's late medieval rather than Viking age. This is a great moment to remind guests that Copenhagen's waterfront has been active for centuries, and major construction often reveals older layers of the city's maritime past.

Today, Operaen is used by The Royal Danish Theatre for opera and ballet productions, and it remains one of the most photographed modern buildings on the harbour.

The Round Tower

Summary

The Round Tower is one of Copenhagen's most famous historic landmarks, built in the 17th century by King Christian IV as part of a scientific complex. Instead of stairs, the tower has a unique spiral ramp leading to an observation deck with panoramic views over the old city. It also houses one of Europe's oldest working observatories and remains a symbol of Denmark's tradition in science and learning.

Description

The Round Tower was built between 1637 and 1642 by King Christian IV as part of a larger project called the Trinitatis Complex. This complex included a church and a university library, and the tower itself was designed mainly for scientific purposes. It still contains one of the oldest functioning observatories in Europe.

What makes the Round Tower unique is that it has no stairs. Instead, visitors walk up a wide spiral ramp that winds around the inside of the tower 7½ times all the way to the top. This design made it possible in the 17th century to bring heavy books and scientific instruments up to the library and observatory using horses and carts.

According to legend, King Christian IV once rode his horse up the ramp to the top, and later the Russian Tsar Peter the Great is said to have driven his carriage up as well. Whether fully true or not, these stories show how wide and gently sloping the ramp is compared to ordinary staircases.

At the top of the tower is an open observation platform that offers one of the best views of Copenhagen's historic center. From here, visitors can see church spires, rooftops, and many of the city's famous landmarks.

Inside the tower, visitors can also experience a modern glass floor section, where they can look straight down into the hollow core of the tower. This creates a dramatic contrast between the historic structure and a modern visitor experience.

The Round Tower reflects Denmark's strong interest in science and education during the Renaissance period. It shows how architecture was designed not only for beauty but also for practical and intellectual purposes.

Today, Rundetårn is both a historical monument and a popular viewpoint. It combines science, legend, and city life in one place and remains one of the most visited attractions in Copenhagen.

The Black Diamond

Summary

The Black Diamond is the modern waterfront extension of Denmark's Royal Library and one of Copenhagen's most striking contemporary buildings. Opened in 1999 and designed by Schmidt Hammer Lassen Architects, it is famous for its shiny black granite façade that reflects the sky and water like a gemstone—giving the building its nickname, “The Black Diamond.” Inside, visitors can explore exhibitions, cultural spaces, and the National Museum of Photography, making it both a library and a cultural landmark by the harbour.

Description

The Black Diamond is the modern part of Denmark's Royal Library and was opened in 1999 as an extension to the historic library building on Slotsholmen. It was designed by the Danish architecture firm Schmidt Hammer Lassen and quickly became a symbol of Copenhagen's modern architectural identity.

The name "Black Diamond" comes from the building's exterior. It is covered with polished black granite imported from Zimbabwe, and its sharp geometric shape reflects the harbour, the sky, and the surrounding city like a dark gemstone. Depending on the light and weather, the building appears to change color and character throughout the day.

Inside, the building opens into a large glass atrium with bridges and staircases connecting different levels. The Black Diamond is not only a library but also a cultural center with exhibition halls, a concert space (Queen's Hall), cafés, and reading rooms.

One of its special features is the National Museum of Photography (Det Nationale Fotomuseum), which is located inside the Black Diamond. The museum presents rotating exhibitions of Danish and international photography and makes the building an important place for visual art as well as literature and research.

This location also tells a deeper historical story. Behind the Black Diamond lies the Royal Library Garden, which was once the site of Christian IV's old naval harbour during the period of absolute monarchy. The harbour was connected to the main harbour by a narrow canal and was used by the Royal Navy to stay close to the political center around Christiansborg Palace and protect the king and the state. Over time, the harbour was filled in and transformed into a garden, showing how Copenhagen has changed from a military and naval city into a cultural capital.

During World War II, the Royal Danish Library played a role in preserving Denmark's cultural resistance by secretly collecting and protecting material from the illegal press, adding another layer of historical importance to the site.

Today, the Black Diamond connects many layers of Copenhagen's history: royal power, naval defense, knowledge, culture, and modern design. It stands as a meeting point between past and present, where visitors can experience architecture, photography, literature, and history in one place by the waterfront

Bishop Absalon Statue

Summary

Absalon (c. 1128–1201) was born in Fjenneslev, Zealand, into a powerful noble family. He became Bishop of Roskilde and was a close advisor (and foster-brother) of King Valdemar I. Absalon became connected to Copenhagen because the king granted him the town of Havn

(the early Copenhagen area). Absalon then built a fortress in 1167 on Slotsholmen to protect the small harbour settlement from attacks, helping the city grow into Copenhagen.

Description.

Absalon (c. 1128–1201) is known as the founder of Copenhagen, but he was not originally from the city. He was born in Fjenneslev on Zealand, in a powerful family with close ties to Danish royalty. He rose to become Bishop of Roskilde and later Archbishop of Lund, and he was one of the most influential political and religious figures in 12th-century Denmark.

Absalon became involved with Copenhagen because King Valdemar I placed trusted people in key roles and awarded Absalon the town of Havn (meaning “harbour/port”), which was the early settlement in the location of modern Copenhagen.

At that time, the area was exposed and vulnerable. In 1167, Absalon built a fortified castle on Slotsholmen to defend the harbour settlement from attacks and strengthen control of the area. This castle is often called Absalon’s Castle, and its ruins can still be seen under Christiansborg today.

Tivoli Gardens

Summary.

Tivoli Gardens is one of the oldest amusement parks in the world, opened in 1843. It is famous for combining rides, gardens, music, restaurants, and lights in the heart of Copenhagen. Tivoli is not just an amusement park but also a cultural space where visitors can enjoy concerts, performances, and seasonal decorations such as summer festivals, Halloween, and Christmas markets. It represents joy, imagination, and entertainment in Danish culture.

Description

Tivoli Gardens was founded in 1843 by Georg Carstensen, with the support of King Christian VIII. His idea was to create a place where people could relax, enjoy culture, and forget everyday problems through music, gardens, and entertainment.

Tivoli quickly became popular among both citizens and visitors and helped shape Copenhagen’s image as a cultural and leisure city. It is one of the oldest still-operating amusement parks in the world.

The park is famous for its beautiful design inspired by Oriental, Chinese, and European architecture, mixed with flowers, lakes, and illuminated buildings. At night, Tivoli becomes especially magical because of thousands of colorful lights.

Tivoli is not only about rides. It is also an important cultural venue with:

- Concerts and ballet performances
- The Tivoli Concert Hall
- Theater and pantomime shows
- Restaurants and cafés

One of its most famous rides is the wooden roller coaster from 1914, one of the oldest still in use in the world. Tivoli also offers modern rides alongside its historic attractions.

Tivoli has inspired famous artists and creators. Walt Disney is said to have visited Tivoli and later used it as inspiration when creating Disneyland.

Throughout the year, Tivoli changes its theme with different seasons:

- Summer festivals
- Halloween decorations
- Christmas markets and lights

This makes Tivoli a living symbol of Copenhagen's ability to combine tradition with modern entertainment. It shows how a place created in the 19th century still plays an important role in the city's cultural and social life today.

Torvehallerne

Summary

Torvehallerne is Copenhagen's modern food market, opened in 2011 near Nørreport Station. It consists of two glass halls with more than 60 food stalls, offering Danish specialties and international cuisine. Visitors can taste fresh seafood, smørrebrød, pastries, chocolate, coffee, and street food while experiencing everyday local life in Copenhagen.

Description

Torvehallerne opened in 2011 and was designed as a modern version of a traditional European market hall. It is located next to Nørreport Station, one of the busiest transport hubs in Copenhagen, which makes it a natural meeting place for locals and visitors.

The market is inspired by classic food halls in cities like Paris and Barcelona, but with a strong Danish focus on fresh ingredients, quality, and design. The two glass halls are connected by an open square and contain more than 60 stalls selling food products from Denmark and around the world.

Torvehallerne is especially known for:

- Danish open sandwiches (smørrebrød)

- Fresh fish and seafood
- Cheese and meat from local producers
- Bakeries and pastries
- Chocolate, coffee, and specialty foods

Unlike many tourist-only food markets, Torvehallerne is mainly used by local people. Copenhagen residents come here to buy ingredients for dinner, meet friends for lunch, or enjoy coffee after work. This makes it a good place to explain Danish food culture and daily life.

Torvehallerne also reflects Copenhagen's modern food identity, which is strongly connected to:

- New Nordic cuisine
- Sustainability and organic products
- High food quality and simple presentation

It shows how Copenhagen combines traditional market culture with modern lifestyle and design. Today, Torvehallerne is both a food destination and a social space where culture, taste, and everyday city life meet.

City Hall (Rådhuset)

Summary

City Hall (Rådhuset) is the seat of the municipal government of Copenhagen, located on Rådhuspladsen (City Hall Square) in central Copenhagen. Completed in 1905, the building is a landmark of the city, notable for its National Romantic architecture and its prominent clock tower overlooking the main square.

Description

Rådhuspladsen, meaning City Hall Square, is one of the most important and lively places in Copenhagen. It has long been a center of public life, where people gather for celebrations, political demonstrations, concerts, and New Year's events.

The square developed in the late 19th and early 20th century together with the construction of Copenhagen City Hall, which was completed in 1905 and designed by architect Martin Nyrop in a National Romantic style inspired by Italian town halls.

Rådhuspladsen marks the transition between old and new Copenhagen. From here begins Strøget, the main pedestrian shopping street that leads into the medieval city center with squares such as Gammeltorv and Nytorv.

Several important monuments are located on the square:

- The statue of Hans Christian Andersen, Denmark's most famous writer
- The Dragon Fountain (Dragespringvandet), symbolizing strength and vitality
- Views of Tivoli Gardens nearby

The square has also been an important traffic and transport hub, connecting major streets and metro lines. Over time, it has changed from a busy road junction into a people-focused urban space.

Rådhuspladsen represents Copenhagen's democratic and social life. It is a place where history, politics, culture, and everyday city life come together. From royal celebrations to football victories and public protests, many of Denmark's most important modern events have taken place here.

Today, Rådhuspladsen is a natural starting point for walking tours and city experiences, showing visitors how Copenhagen combines historic identity with modern urban life.

The Meatpacking District

Summary

The Meatpacking District, known in Danish as Kødbyen, is a former slaughterhouse and meat industry area that has been transformed into one of Copenhagen's trendiest neighborhoods.

Today, it is famous for its restaurants, cafés, galleries, nightlife, and creative businesses, while still preserving its industrial buildings from the early 20th century.

Description

The Meatpacking District, or Kødbyen, was developed in the late 19th and early 20th centuries as Copenhagen's central area for meat production, slaughterhouses, and food distribution. It played an important role in improving hygiene and food safety in a growing industrial city.

Kødbyen is divided into three historical sections:

- Brown Meat District (Den Brune Kødby) – the oldest part, built in the late 1800s with brick buildings
- White Meat District (Den Hvide Kødby) – built in the 1930s in a functionalist style with white buildings
- Grey Meat District (Den Grå Kødby) – later industrial expansions

For many decades, this area supplied meat to the entire city of Copenhagen and was a working industrial zone filled with butchers, workers, and refrigerated warehouses.

From the 1990s and 2000s onward, meat production slowly declined, and the city began transforming the district into a new urban space for culture and business. Old slaughterhouses and factories were converted into:

- restaurants and food halls
- art galleries and design studios
- music venues and nightclubs
- creative offices

Today, the Meatpacking District is one of Copenhagen's main centers for:

- modern Danish cuisine
- nightlife and social life
- creative industries

It represents how Copenhagen reuses its industrial heritage instead of demolishing it. The mix of historic factory buildings and modern culture shows the city's approach to urban regeneration and sustainability.

Kødbyen is especially lively in the evenings and weekends, when locals gather here for dining and nightlife. During the daytime, it still has food wholesalers and businesses operating, keeping a connection to its original purpose.

The Meatpacking District tells the story of Copenhagen's change from an industrial port city into a modern, creative capital.

Langelinie Cruise Terminals

Summary

Langelinie and Nordhavn are the main cruise docking areas of Copenhagen, where thousands of cruise passengers arrive each summer. On busy days during the cruise season, several ships can dock across these two terminals. Historically, this area developed as part of Copenhagen's harbour and port infrastructure and later became connected to transport and industrial activities. Today, it serves as an important gateway for visitors arriving by sea and marks the starting point for exploring the city.

Description

Langelinie and Nordhavn are operated as official cruise terminals by Copenhagen Malmö Port (CMP) and are part of Copenhagen's long maritime tradition. These terminals handle most of the city's international cruise traffic and are especially active during the summer months, when Copenhagen is one of Northern Europe's most popular cruise destinations.

The Langelinie area was developed as part of Copenhagen's harbour expansion in the late 19th century. The quay was constructed in 1894 to allow large ships to dock close to the city.

Before becoming a cruise terminal, this waterfront zone was closely connected to port activity, trade, and transport infrastructure. The surrounding area also formed part of Copenhagen's former defensive and harbour landscape and later evolved into a public promenade.

Nordhavn, where the modern Ocean Quay (Oceankaj) is located, represents Copenhagen's transformation from an industrial port into a contemporary harbour district. Originally designed for cargo handling and industrial use, Nordhavn has gradually been redeveloped into a mixed area of harbour facilities, business zones, and modern urban development, while still functioning as an important cruise docking point.

Together, Langelinie and Nordhavn illustrate how Copenhagen has developed from a historic trading port into a modern maritime capital welcoming visitors from around the world. For cruise passengers, these terminals are not only arrival points but also the beginning of their encounter with Copenhagen's history, culture, and waterfront cityscape.

Genetically Modified Paradise

Summary

Genetically Modified Paradise (Det Genmodificerede Paradis) is a modern sculpture created for the World Expo 2000 in Hannover, Germany. The artwork was designed by the Danish artist Bjørn Nørgaard and reflects ideas about science, technology, and human influence on nature. After the Expo, the sculpture was installed in Copenhagen near the harbour close to the Little Mermaid area, where it forms part of the city's public art and cultural landscape.

The artwork consists of multiple sculptural elements, including figures positioned both on land and in the water. Among them is a bronze mermaid statue placed directly in the harbour, made from the same material as the famous Little Mermaid. This mermaid is slightly larger in size, offering an interesting visual comparison and highlighting Copenhagen's tradition of combining mythology with modern artistic expression.

Description

Genetically Modified Paradise was originally created for Expo 2000 in Hannover, a world exhibition with the main theme of humanity, technology, and the future. Denmark participated in the exhibition with artistic and cultural contributions, and this sculpture was part of that international presentation.

The work was designed by Bjørn Nørgaard, one of Denmark's most important contemporary artists. He is also known for creating the modern tapestries inside Christiansborg Palace and

for many public artworks across Denmark. With this sculpture, Nørgaard explored the idea of a “paradise” that has been changed and shaped by human scientific intervention.

The sculpture symbolically represents how modern science and genetic technology can alter nature. It invites viewers to reflect on the balance between progress and responsibility and raises questions about how far humans should go in modifying natural life.

After Expo 2000 ended, the sculpture was transferred to Copenhagen and placed near the waterfront at Langelinie, close to the Little Mermaid and Kastellet. Its location connects contemporary art with Copenhagen’s historic harbour area and popular tourist route.

Today, Genetically Modified Paradise stands as a reminder of the global discussion about technology, nature, and ethics at the turn of the 21st century. It adds a modern artistic perspective to an area otherwise dominated by royal monuments and historic landmarks, showing how Copenhagen combines tradition with contemporary cultural expression.

The Polar Bear (*Isbjørn med unger*)

Summary

The Polar Bear with Cubs (*Isbjørn med unger*) is a bronze sculpture located at Langelinie Quay in Copenhagen and is often described as a small landmark symbolizing Greenland’s presence in the city. The statue is famous for the bullet damage on the bear’s head, which dates back to the period of the German occupation during World War II. The marks are still visible today

Description

Isbjørn med unger was created by the Danish sculptor Holger Wederkinch and is placed at Langelinie as part of Copenhagen’s harbour promenade, an area that also includes other monuments and sculptures. The work became known internationally after being exhibited in 1929, where it received a gold medal, before later being installed at Langelinie.

During World War II, Denmark was occupied by Nazi Germany (1940–1945). In that period, the polar bear sculpture was shot in the head by a German soldier, leaving visible bullet marks. These marks were not removed and remain part of the statue’s appearance. Visitors are often told to look closely at the bear’s head to see the hole/bullet damage, which has become one of the statue’s most memorable details.

Today, the Polar Bear sculpture functions both as public art and as a quiet reminder that even Copenhagen’s peaceful waterfront carries traces of wartime history—while also appearing in Greenland-related storytelling about Copenhagen’s historical connections to the Arctic.

The source is ([🌐 Have some Greenland in Copenhagen - Visit Greenland](#))

Royal Pavilions (De Kongelige Pavilloner)

Summary

The Royal Pavilions at Nordre Toldbod are two small historic buildings created in 1905 to serve as waiting and reception shelters for the Danish Royal Family when arriving or departing by sea. They are closely connected to royal maritime traditions and ceremonies involving the Royal Yacht *Dannebrog*.

Description

Before modern air travel, official royal journeys often took place by ship, and Copenhagen's harbour played an important role in royal transport. Nordre Toldbod became one of the main arrival and departure points for the Royal Family. To protect the King and royal guests from wind and rain while waiting at the quay, two pavilions were built in 1905 as permanent structures instead of temporary tents.

The two pavilions are distinguished by their symbols: one is marked with a royal crown and was intended for the monarch, while the other was used by members of the royal household and accompanying officials. Together, they formed part of the ceremonial setting for royal sea travel.

The Royal Pavilions are especially associated with events involving the Royal Yacht *Dannebrog*, which has long served as the Danish monarch's official ship for state visits and summer voyages. When the royal family boards or disembarks from the yacht in Copenhagen, the area around Nordre Toldbod and the pavilions becomes a place of official ceremony and tradition.

Today, the Royal Pavilions remain a visible symbol of the connection between the Danish monarchy and Copenhagen's harbour. They illustrate how the waterfront was once an important stage for royal arrivals and public events and how maritime travel shaped Denmark's royal and national history.

Maersk Headquarters

Summary

Maersk Headquarters is located at Esplanaden 50 in central Copenhagen, close to Kastellet, Amalienborg, and the inner harbour. Maersk is a global transport and logistics company founded in 1904, and the Esplanaden address has become closely associated with the

company's leadership and corporate identity. The headquarters building is a visible symbol of Copenhagen's long maritime and shipping tradition.

Description

Maersk's main Copenhagen address is Esplanaden 50. This is repeatedly listed as the company's Copenhagen headquarters / office address in Maersk's official contact information and documents.

The location is strategically placed near Copenhagen's historic harbour area, reflecting Maersk's roots in shipping and Denmark's long relationship with maritime trade. Maersk was established in 1904 and grew into one of the world's most influential companies in shipping and logistics.

In Copenhagen, "Esplanaden" is often used as a shorthand reference to Maersk's top management, showing how strongly the company is linked to this address in Danish public life.

For visitors following your bike route, the Maersk headquarters works well as a short storytelling stop: it connects the city's royal harbour landscape (Amalienborg / Nordre Toldbod) with Copenhagen's modern global shipping and logistics role.

Michelangelo's David (Replica)

Summary

A replica of Michelangelo's famous statue *David* arrived in Copenhagen in **1896** and was placed in a prominent public area near **Copenhagen Central Station**. The statue caused public debate at the time because of its nudity, which many people considered inappropriate for display in a public space.

Description

In 1896, a full-size replica of Michelangelo's Renaissance masterpiece *David* was brought to Copenhagen as part of a growing interest in classical art and sculpture. It was installed near the Central Station area, where many citizens and visitors could see it daily.

Soon after its installation, the statue became controversial. Newspapers and members of the public criticized it for showing a completely nude male figure, which conflicted with the moral standards of the period. While some defended it as an important work of art, others believed it did not belong in the city's public environment.

Because of the debate and discomfort it created, the statue was later removed from its original location. Today, it is remembered mainly for the discussion it provoked about art, morality, and the role of public sculpture in Copenhagen at the end of the 19th century.

Broens Street Food

Summary

Broens Street Food is a seasonal street food market located at the Greenlandic Trading Square (Grønlandske Handelsplads) right by Inderhavnsbroen (the Inner Harbour Bridge) between Nyhavn and Christianshavn. Opened in 2018, it is known for combining food stalls, waterfront views, and a lively atmosphere. The market offers a mix of Danish-inspired options and international street food, making it a popular stop for both locals and visitors.

Description

If you cycle from Nyhavn toward Christianshavn, Broens Street Food is one of the first major stops you reach after crossing Inderhavnsbroen. It sits directly on Grønlandske Handelsplads, a historic harbour area that was established in 1735 and long connected to trade and maritime activity. Today, the area also includes cultural institutions such as Nordatlantens Brygge (North Atlantic House), highlighting Copenhagen's links to the North Atlantic region.

Broens Street Food opened in 2018 and is presented as a curated food market with stalls and carts that can change with the season. Rather than being only “traditional Danish food,” it is better described as a mix of Copenhagen street-food concepts, including Danish-focused options alongside international kitchens, with an emphasis on quality and an organic focus mentioned by VisitCopenhagen.

Because of its location by the water, Broens is also a strong “Copenhagen moment” on the route: you can pause for a quick meal or drink while enjoying harbour views, and then continue easily either deeper into Christianshavn or onward toward the Opera House and the rest of the harbour route.

Circle Bridge (Cirkelbroen)

Summary

The Circle Bridge (Cirkelbroen) is a pedestrian and bicycle bridge designed by the Danish-Icelandic artist Olafur Eliasson and opened in 2015. It is located directly opposite The Black Diamond (Royal Library) and offers one of the best viewpoints of the harbour front and Slotsholmen, the historic island of power and culture in Copenhagen.

Description

Cirkelbroen was created as both a functional bridge and an artistic structure. Designed by Olafur Eliasson, the bridge is made up of several circular platforms connected together and supported by tall masts inspired by the rigging of old sailing ships. This design reflects

Copenhagen's long maritime history and its modern identity as a city shaped by water and movement.

The bridge crosses Christianshavn Canal and lies directly opposite the Black Diamond, the modern extension of the Royal Library. From the Circle Bridge, visitors can enjoy clear views of the Black Diamond's reflective black granite façade as well as the buildings of Slotsholmen, including Christiansborg Palace and historic waterfront structures.

Because of its central position, the Circle Bridge has become a popular stopping point for cyclists and pedestrians to take photographs and observe the contrast between modern architecture and historic institutions. It connects Christianshavn with the cultural and political heart of the city and functions as both a crossing and a viewing platform.

Today, Cirkelbroen demonstrates how Copenhagen combines infrastructure with art and urban design. It transforms an everyday bridge into a cultural landmark and provides one of the most scenic perspectives on the harbour, linking contemporary architecture with the historic core of the city.

Kissing Bridge (Bryggebroen)

Summary

The Kissing Bridge, officially known as Bryggebroen, is a pedestrian and bicycle bridge connecting Islands Brygge with Kalvebod Brygge in central Copenhagen. Opened in 2006, the bridge was built as part of the city's harbour redevelopment and supports Copenhagen's strong focus on cycling and sustainable urban transport.

Description

Bryggebroen was constructed during a period when Copenhagen was transforming its former industrial harbour into residential and recreational waterfront areas. The bridge created a direct and safe connection between Islands Brygge and the city centre, making it easier for pedestrians and cyclists to move across the harbour without using motor traffic routes.

The bridge's curved shape has given rise to its popular nickname, "the Kissing Bridge," because the two sides appear to lean toward each other like they are meeting in the middle. This design also allows ships and boats to pass underneath while maintaining a smooth and continuous path for cyclists and walkers.

Bryggebroen plays an important role in Copenhagen's everyday life. Thousands of commuters use it daily, making it one of the city's most important non-motorized crossings. It reflects Copenhagen's long-term investment in bicycle infrastructure and its ambition to create a livable, people-friendly harbour environment.

Today, the Kissing Bridge is not only a transport link but also a viewpoint over the harbour, offering views toward Islands Brygge, the modern waterfront developments, and the inner city skyline. It symbolizes Copenhagen's shift from an industrial port to a modern urban waterfront focused on mobility, leisure, and sustainability.